



THE DIAMOND CHRONICLER

THE BRUNSVIK TREATY

The Imperial Federation and the Kingdom of Salerno adopted the Treaty of Brunsvik earlier this month, officially creating a mutual defensive and commercial alliance between themselves. The alliance seeks to further the amicable relations between the I.F. and Salerno by committing them to greater military and commercial cooperation. The treaty, adopted by the I.F. on Dec. 8 and by Salerno on Dec. 9, requires that both signatories enter into an alliance of mutual military and commercial cooperation. "Salerno and the Imperial Federation will commit to deepening bi-lateral ties through increased cooperation in the future, spearheaded by their respective diplomatic missions," the treaty states.

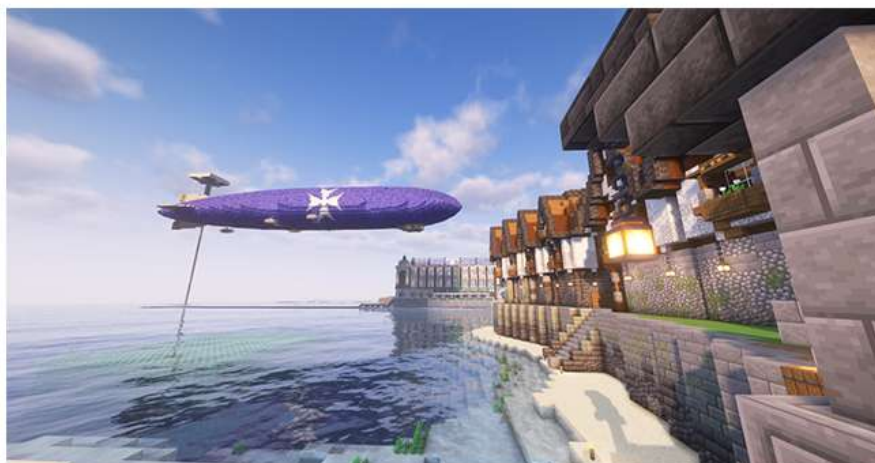
"This cooperation will be on both commercial and military matters and at the discretion of their respective governments." - *Continues on page 2...*

FAIRNESS OF VOLUTIONFS'S TRIAL QUESTIONED

The Diamond Chronicler ran a poll of public sentiment of the I.F. trials of four Karydian Union officials on Nov. 26. These are the major takeaways of the poll. Very little change in public sentiment of the Karydian government after the trials. The poll of 19 respondents suggests that views largely did not change despite the trials. Most people, the poll suggests, have a favorable or neutral view of the Karydian government. The unchanged views are hinted at by the fact that the makeup of answers to the first and second questions of the poll are very similar to one another. The first question of the poll asked how favorably or unfavorably the respondent had viewed the Karydian government before the trials began, while the second question asked for the respondent's view after the trials had ended. - *Continues on page 3...*

Although the treaty mandates a defensive alliance between the two countries, it does not require either signatory to aid the other's war efforts on account of other alliances. "This [military] commitment may also be extended to justified offensive wars agreed upon by both parties, but will not be extended to construe wars which one party is involved in by virtue of another alliance," the treaty states. One I.F. alliance that Salerno didn't want to be involved in with the adoption of the Treaty of the Brunsvik was the Antarctic Treaty Entity, since it includes nations with which Salerno has had little contact. "With the exception of the IF, the ATE seems to be an alliance weighted towards Alenarith, and it by in large consists of nations that we have generally had far less contact with than with the IF," realmichael, Salerno's foreign minister, told the Chronicler. Ultimately, the I.F. government was fine with keeping other alliances out of the treaty. "[Salerno wasn't] interested in joining ATE and we are fine with keeping it that way," slothinasuit, the head of the I.F. defense department, told the Chronicler. The treaty enjoys popularity among officials from both the I.F. and Salerno, who have hailed it as a means to further military and commercial interests shared by both countries. "[Our alliance with the I.F.] should result in safer and richer salernites," bronnakus, the prime minister of Salerno, told the Chronicler. "The IF should be thrilled it's getting rich trading partners and a capable military ally." The newfound I.F.-Salerno alliance is the culmination of months of negotiations between the governments of the I.F. and Salerno, according to realmichael, who helped to negotiate the alliance on his nation's behalf. "[An I.F.-Salerno alliance] was floated around as an idea by various IF officials since the re-establishment of Salerno," realmichael said. "But Sloth [the head of the I.F. defense department] & Asgeir [the chancellor of the I.F.] took the initiative to formally suggest it following Asgeir's election as Chancellor."

Although the Treaty of Brunsvik enjoys popularity among many I.F. and Salerno officials, a few prominent citizens from both countries have expressed opposition to it. On the I.F.'s side, senator PumpkinPie123 was the sole vote against the treaty in the I.F. senate. He told the Chronicler that his opposition comes from his negative views of the Salerno people. "Salerno is a bunch of brain dead individuals that got brain rot from sucking chachas [Coolchacha97's] dick," PumpkinPie123 said. On Salerno's side, Coolchacha97, a former member of Salerno's royal parliament, told the Chronicler that his opposition to the treaty comes from his concerns for his nation's ability to further its foreign policy interests. "If you ally to the IF you lose your ability to set foriegn policy that the IF doesnt approve of," Coolchacha97 said. On the topic of I.F. criticism, while the I.F. and Salerno are now military allies, the Salerno government said that it dislikes the I.F.'s perceived propensity to expand its borders without using the land it engulfs. "Salerno as a nation upholds the principle that claims should only be based on what one actively uses and needs," bronnakus said. "Especially as allies we would hope they'd [the I.F.] adopt a similar stance and give less power to the map-painting majority." slothinasuit said that the I.F. doesn't care much for Salerno's concerns about its territorial policy. "Bronnakus says these things and the IF's statement on this will be asking bronnakus to cope and seethe," slothinasuit said. Despite oppositional voices to the Treaty of Brunsvik and disagreements over territorial policy, the I.F. and Salerno are happy to be newfound allies. "We have fairly good relations with Salerno and our interest in regional stability align," warendrop, the vice chancellor of the I.F., told the Chronicler. "So an Alliance is a natural extension of that."



Salerno's new blimp,
photo by realmichael

Initially, more than half of respondents (12/19) answered that they had had a favorable or neutral view of the Karydian government before the trials began. After the trials had ended, that figure stayed roughly the same, rising to 14/19 respondents having a favorable or neutral view of the Karydian government. Given how unchanged sentiment appears to be of the Karydian government, it seems that the trials did little to affect people's opinions on the Karydian Union. Respondents were more divided on their answers to the third and fourth questions of the poll. The questions asked respectively how well or poorly the respondent thought the I.F. judiciary had conducted itself during the trials, and whether or not the respondent thought the judiciary needed to be reformed. A plurality of respondents (6/19) answered that they thought the I.F. judiciary had conducted itself "Well" during the trials.

However, five of the nineteen respondents answered that the judiciary had conducted itself "Poorly." This suggests that views are more split on whether or not the I.F. judiciary had conducted itself well or poorly during the trial of four Karydian officials. In addition, when asked whether or not the respondents thought the I.F. judiciary needed to be reformed, a tight majority of respondents (10/19) answered "No," while the rest (9/19) answered "Yes." This suggests that views are equally split on whether the I.F. judiciary is not functioning well enough, given how many respondents believe the justice system needs reform. Opinions are also split on VolutionFs' sentence and punishment was just

VolutionFs, the former president of the Karydian Union, pleaded no contest to the charges against him in his trial, which included conspiracy, aiding and abetting, treason, espionage, and terrorism. His punishment was to be pearled for two months, pay hefty reparations to various parties, and have his I.F. citizenship revoked. Opinions are split again on whether this punishment was just, as a slim majority of respondents (11/19) answered that VolutionFs had indeed received a just punishment, while the rest (8/19) answered that he hadn't. Ultimately, this poll shows that beyond the reputation of the Karydian government after the trials, public sentiment is rather divided

on the four trials.

How well or poorly the I.F. judiciary conducted itself, whether it needs reforms, and whether VolutionFs received a just punishment are questions that the public is split over.